

features of Windows XP. The solution to your problem is to download and install the latest drivers for your mouse, and if the drivers support power management, your mouse should work after hibernation or standby.

Please send us the full configuration details of your system when writing in to us so we can be of more help.

Camera Prefers 98

Q I am using an icam Robo - 351 Web cam. I have Windows 98 SE and Windows XP (dual-booting). In Windows 98 SE, the cam works fine, but in XP, when the cam is started, the video stops within 10 seconds. Then I get an error message: "Error 80070450: cannot preview graph." I tried re-installing the driver from the Web site, but the problem persists. I also happen to have a Pinnacle TV-Tuner card.

C S Laxmi, via e-mail

A First, install the latest version of DirectX for your version of Windows. You can get this from the Microsoft Web site or from one of the *Digit* DVDs. You will also need to install the latest drivers for your TV-Tuner card from www.pinnaclesys.com.

Swap OSes

Q I have installed Windows XP Professional on both my hard disks. Can I reverse the order in which the OS choice is displayed in the OS option menu?

Hemant Sahi, via e-mail

A All you need to do is edit the boot.ini file, which resides in the root of your system drive. Enter "%systemdrive%/boot.ini" into the Run dialog box. Boot.ini will open in Notepad. The file is divided into two sections—"Boot loader" and "Operating Systems". The two OS options for your PC will be mentioned under "Operating Systems", in two lines. You can edit this and reverse the order of how the OSes are displayed. In order to change the default OS, change the text in the line next to "default=" to that which matches the OS into which you wish to boot first.

Codec Issues

Q I used Windows MovieMaker 2 to create some movie files. When I copied the files to a Compaq Presario laptop, the files I'd created played on the laptop as audio files instead of as videos. All I could view were some visualisations. They'd worked perfectly on my computer. The Compaq laptop had Windows Media Player 9 installed on it.

Swathy Sudarsanan, via e-mail

A Windows MovieMaker 2 uses Windows Media Codec 10. The Compaq laptop which had WMP 9 installed could not play your files because these codecs were not installed. In

order to play the videos you created, you need to install Windows Media Player 10, which includes Windows Media Codec 10.

Access Gone Awry

Q I was working on Microsoft Access when there was a sudden power failure, and all my data got deleted or corrupted. Is there a way to restore data from corrupted Access files?

Sajan Mishra, via e-mail

A There are several utilities that attempt to recover corrupt MS Access files. One such utility is AccessFIX from Cimaware Software, which can restore damaged database files and rebuild table data even if the files are password-protected. You can download a free demo from www.cimaware.com.

Sticky Windows

Q I've got keyboard problems. When I press [D], all open windows get minimised. When I press [M], the active window is minimised. When [U] is pressed, the utility manager opens. On pressing [L], my computer gets locked. I have these problems even when several applications are open. I even formatted my hard drive and re-installed Windows, but I'm still facing this problem!

Bhabatitdev Das, via e-mail

A The only possible cause of your problem is that the Window key of your keyboard is stuck. This happens because of dust accumulating in the keyboard, and the keyboard getting dirty in general. Try to release the key, and if possible, clean and service your keyboard because this problem may occur with the other keys as well.

LAN Woes

Q I have a Pentium IV on an Intel 915 motherboard with onboard LAN (Intel Pro VE 10/100), and I'm using Windows XP SP2. The drivers for the LAN were successfully installed from the motherboard's driver CD, but XP always shows that the network cable is unplugged.

Rajiv Chopra, via e-mail



Set the link speed of the network adapter

A This can happen when there is a link speed mismatch between that set for the network adapter and that available on the network. If you do not know what the speed of your local area network is, you can try setting various speeds for your network adapter. To do this, open 'Network Connections' from the Control Panel. Right-click on the network